Compy Site Design

The original is on ws.baldvin.net (you may be looking at the original)

User stories

Personas are reference to the canonical set in personas.html, or the to-be-worked-out ones from the input material for additional personas, of from the personas whiteboard.

Michael – idealistic math teacher

I have an upcoming camp

I have an upcoming camp, and already ideas what I will do. I may include some from Compy, let me see if there's something light-weight.

If reading the site suggest that it's all-or-nothing 8 week, then I can't use it. If I can take a piece here and there, I might even be interested.

Anna – gentle parent

I would like my kid to try some science activities, to see if he enjoys it

There's some time in the summer, and I am looking for some activities for my kid. I am looking for a safe environment, where there is a positive atmosphere with other kids. Maybe he would be interested about science and programming, he should be able to find it out there.

Elena – tiger mother

My kid needs to spend time efficiently to get ahead

In this empty time during schoolbreak my kid should acquire competitive knowledge, that prepares him for the future. Programming and math will be a useful skill when later he goes to study AI in Oxford.

Mrs. Mathilda – school principal

I need to present why my school is special

I need to communicate to stakeholders (parents, owners) of my school, and demonstrate the value they are getting from our school.

Principles

- When I look at it, I should not feel that they are pushing something on me
- Should be attractive for co-creation, instead of suggesting that a company controls the full experience
- Mobile experience is first-class (they check us out there first)
- Should not alienate the developers of Compy.

Design requirements

- The fact that it is open-source should be mentioned – even with a link.
- Primarily present cherry-picked presentation of possible exercises, and separately present that there is also an 8-lesson fix plan.
    - *Note: we need to first to cater for Michael's needs, the second for Mrs. Mathilda's needs.*
- Responsive design, with mobile as a first class citizen.

Highlights

- Open source
- Principled simplicity, look into the source of everything
- Robotics, math, physics via doing
- Full course material available, or just use bits and pieces, play around
- From ages 4-6, up to 14, with different exercises

Related material

- Worked out personas: https://compy-dev.educationmatters.ch/personas.html
- Input material for additional personas: https://ws.baldvin.net/f/22592
- Whiteboard for new personas: https://ws.baldvin.net/f/24489

Experiments

Site1

https://compy-club-dev.educationmatters.ch/site1

A super heavy-weight, standard corporate-feel site

Reactions

I would go even a bit further. ***The entire first version felt like an all-out assault.***
I think, you are making the mistake you keep warning us against: explaining too much.

Notes

- We should consider different styles. Maybe it should be rather just blog-like. Or social stream-like.
- Overall, the target audience should feel not that something is pushed to them, but that they want to know more.
- We may consider looking into ho we feel about a design, but also we should consider our parent personas (currently not included in the personas, we should)

Site2

https://compy-club-dev.educationmatters.ch/site2

A leaner version of site1, with the corporate fake energy removed.

Reactions

- *I like it much better as the previous one.*
- *I dunno, better, but something is still off.*

Notes

The enterprise taste of the first version was largely because it attempts to explicitly dictate the reader's emotions, instead of enabling the emotions to develop in the reader, by the reader.

The second version consciously reduces that, and so it is less wrong. However, it is still not good: when we enumerate the various personas, the second version still does not talk to them.

For example, if I'm a teacher, the second version still does not make me feel that I'll be deciding what, when, and how to use. I want this system to give value to me, not limit me.

If I'm a tiger mother, I want to see that it adheres to my principles. There is a lot of text about principles, but literally none of it helps me see why it increases my child's competitiveness and chances to get to top high education, for example.

The site has a heavy emphasis on theoretical principles, which are great for the child – but they do not talk *to the child*, they are *about the child*. That material is good for publications, supplementary material, etc, but not for front-matter.

The wall of text that it has is not helpful when it comes to the mobile version – and most likely the mobile version will be the one where most users check us out first.

Site3

- https://compy-club-dev.educationmatters.ch/site3 CompyVisual
- COMPY_VISUAL_ELEMENTS
- Compy_games_figures
- maze_robot

Reactions

- *Has too much of "open source vibe", talking to the math teacher, but not to the parent and the school principle.*
- *It think, it's a bit text-heavy. Couldn't some of these things be better communicated visually?*

Notes

The most problematic thing: "things you can run" – people bounce off, even without reading it, or skip at least where seemingly there are some commands.

We may want to de-emphasize the commands.

In the cards we should have visuals. Pictures, small videos, animated elements. The title can be “run maze”, etc, so that could work for both audiences.

Specifically with the visual style: the title can be styled as a console command, white on black, or light grey on black, have association for console: non-programmer types won’t even see that, they will see another part of the card emphasized.

Think this is the right direction, need to push.

Dani wants a wiki – says it adds a good vibe.

Danila does not agree, but is too polite so says “half agree”. Wiki should be hidden behind burger.

Elecfreaks is differentiating by target audience: www.elecfreaks.com leads to the shop. They are differentiating by target customer. Dani: we should too.

Danila’s suggestion:

- Have something for everyone on the first page like it is on site3
    - Just push it further and make it more gen-population friendly
    - This might be the next step
- Have prominent links from those 3 sections, which lead to 3 different sites
    - Those are organized differently
    - One: shop, to buy the computer
    - Two: wiki/open source stuff
    - Third: methodology, for teachers, principles, like that

Danila: a lot of elements from site1, sites2 and Linda’s mock-ups should be reused

AI(Danila): write up some elements that you think are candidates for this

Linda’s site design: https://git.baldvin.net/educationmatters/compy-project/src/branch/main/club-comms/club-website/linda-site.jpeg

Ideas, concepts for new experiments

- A site that has similar information, but significantly less presented upfront
- A blog-like site, where much of the information is presented as form of articles